best, a much more sophisticated and systematic version of Middle Eastern coloniality.

I consciously use the words ‘sophisticated’ and ‘systematic’, since Middle Eastern colonialism’s predominant use of force inspired a similar response, which made it possible for Bharat’s indigeneity to offer fierce resistance and survive where other cultures and civilisations were wiped out for eternity. The expression of contempt and the intention to annihilate the other was worn on the sleeve by Middle Eastern coloniality, and therefore, the other (Bharat’s indigeneity) was acutely aware of the need to defend itself. On the contrary, European coloniality’s use of institutional mechanisms to co-opt the indigenous society and project Europeanism as the aspirational goal, lulled the indigenous consciousness into a false sense of comfort that coexistence was possible. The indigenous society seemed to have bought into the stated policy of ‘toleration’ of the European coloniser whose end goal it was oblivious to. And yet, the postcolonial school actively obstructs scrutiny of either coloniality, forget calling them out, despite the fact that both forms of colonialities are alive and kicking within contemporary Bharat at the expense of the indigenous consciousness.

Further, notwithstanding its self-image and professions of challenging coloniality’s monopoly over time and subjectivity, the fact remains that postcolonial thought’s characterisation of who or what constitutes ‘subaltern’ in Bharat itself is loaded with coloniality since it is informed by colonial assumptions of the native society and its societal structures, specifically the ‘caste system’. In addition to this, at least insofar as Bharat is concerned, the postcolonial and the Marxist schools have forged a collaborative partnership, in the sense that both advance European and Middle Eastern colonialities in their own ways by creating divisions within the indigenous consciousness or by digesting it, ‘subalternism’ being a case in point.

This may not be surprising given Marx’s own Eurocentrism and avowed belief that British colonialism was good for Bharat.[9] Marx believed that England had to fulfil ‘a double mission in India’, namely the annihilation of the old Asiatic society, and the laying of the material foundations of Western society in Asia.[10] These were his views despite his own knowledge of the selfish nature of British colonisation of Bharat, best captured by his statement that ‘whatever may have been the crimes of England she was the unconscious tool of history in bringing about that revolution’, that is, in